Mobile Game “Gate” Placement A/B Testing

Introduction

Mobile games frequently incorporate “gates” into their games. As a player progresses past certain levels, they will be forced to either wait a certain period of time or pay in order to continue through the gate. This gate serves two primary purposes:

1. Increase in-app purchases
2. Increase player satisfaction through forced breaks

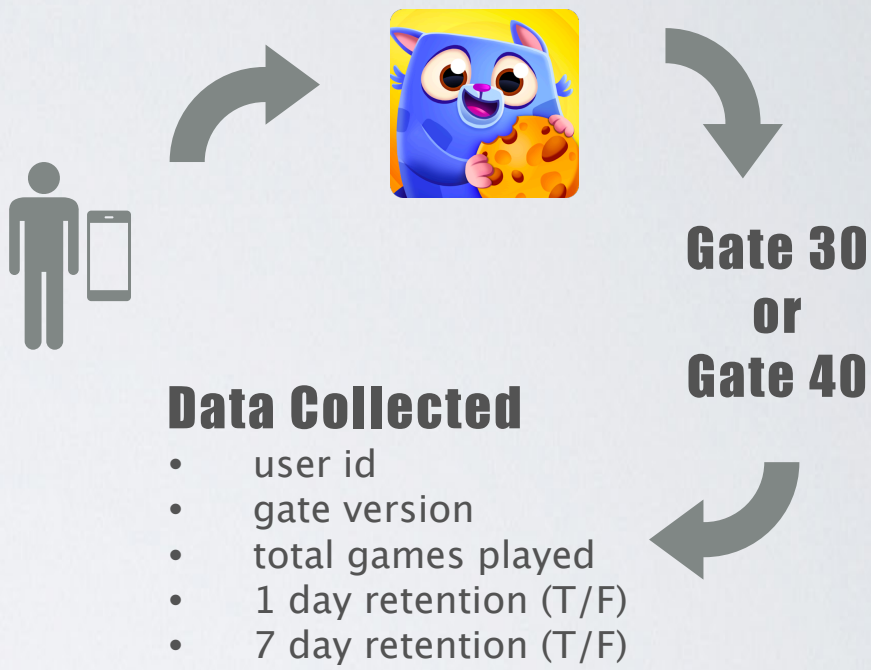
The data for this analysis comes from DataCamp: “Mobile Games A/B Testing with Cookie Cats”.

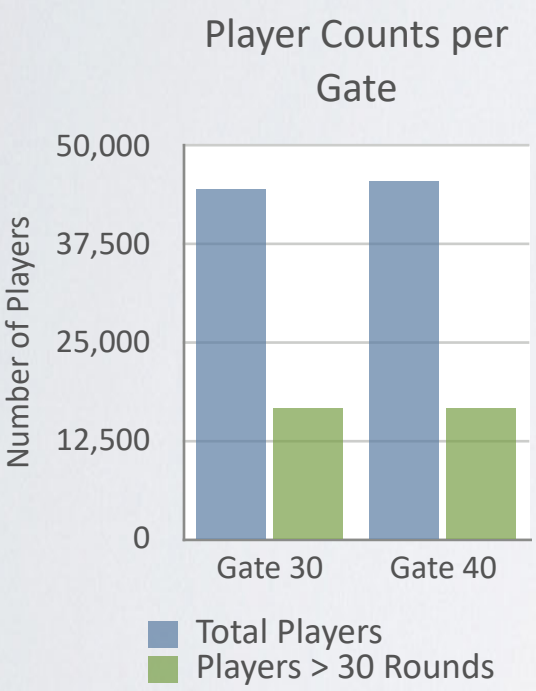
Analysis Goals

The focus of this A/B test is to use weekly games played and retention rates to determine which level this gate should be placed (level 30 or level 40) for the popular mobile game Cookie Cats.

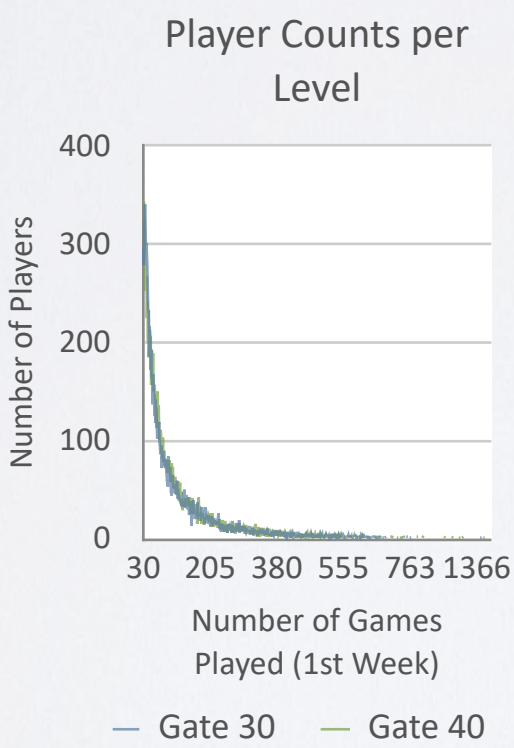
Data Collection

As players download the mobile application, they are randomly assigned to a different first gate level. Their data for the first week of playing was then collected. See graphic to the right:





- Players were evenly distributed between the two levels.
- Due to the number of players who never reached the minimum level for a gate, they will need to be excluded.



- There does not appear to be a significant difference between the different gates and how many levels people play in their first week. Statistical analysis will provide greater insight.

Retention by Gate and Day

1 Day	Retention Rate	*7 Day*	Retention Rate
Gate 30	44.48%	**Gate 30**	26.95%
Gate 40	44.5%	**Gate 40**	26.62%
P-value	**0.85**	P-value	**0.11**

Conclusion

Retention rates seem to be unaffected by which level the gate is placed at. While the 7 day retention appears to favor the gate at level 30, the statistical significance is still relatively low with a p-value of 0.11. The statistical test used for both was a 2 sample test for proportions. Additional gate options may be useful in determining the most effective level to place the gate.